

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at Novo Nordisk,

I trained as an architect, and the interest that has run alongside that from the beginning is data - using it to understand what has been built and what could be built better. That is what took me from architecture practice into feasibility and analysis, and then to a Master's in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy, a programme built around using data and technology to improve the decisions made in real estate and construction. The through line has been consistent, which is that I would rather build the analytical tool that answers a question than argue the question without one. Novo Nordisk's Planning Solution Development team works on the far side of that preference, since a planning solution improves decisions only once the people planning against it trust it and use it as intended.

During my time in Ramboll Management Consulting's Responsible Business Conduct team I ran human rights due diligence for corporate clients under the UN Guiding Principles and the OECD Guidelines, and in practice a large part of that was data work. I built a fully automated risk assessment system in Excel that consolidated supply chain risk data into a single dashboard which updated salient risks dynamically, an impact assessment tool that scored more than forty risks by severity so the most material ones surfaced first, and a mapping of the supply chains of over twenty critical raw materials under the EU Critical Raw Materials Act. The common task underneath all of it was taking broad and uneven bodies of evidence and structuring them rigorously enough to produce scored, defensible outputs. Gathering requirements from users across sites and converting them into clear stories, features and a maintained backlog is that same structuring task applied to business needs rather than risk evidence.

At Isay Weinfeld Architects I wrote a Grasshopper plugin in Python that generates bespoke staircases directly from a floor plan, which took a task that had run to several days down to roughly twenty minutes and made a far wider range of geometry testable within a project timeline. Building it was the smaller half of the work - the rest was sitting with the colleagues who had been doing it by hand to establish what they actually needed, presenting the tool in a studio workshop, and supporting its adoption across more than ten projects afterwards, which taught me that a tool nobody trusts enough to use has not been finished. Supporting planning teams and Super Users in adopting standard solutions, and documenting them well enough to be used as designed, is the part of solution work that matters most.

Novo Nordisk plans a heavily regulated supply chain across sites and geographies, where standardising how planning is done is a problem of process, systems and people at the same time. That is where I want to keep doing the work I find most worthwhile, which is turning large and awkward bodies of data into something a business can decide on.

Best,

Antonio Carmagnani